PRANA 🫁 · SETUP GUIDE

PRANA inside your AI agents

Plug PRANA's brain into Claude Code, Claude Desktop, Cursor, ChatGPT Desktop & Gemini CLI via MCP. One command does it all.

1 command	5 tools	6 agents
prana-setup	exposed via MCP	supported

🤖 AUTOMATIC — prana-setup does it 👆 YOUR STEP — restart the app / paste a block

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◈ What you're building

MCP (Model Context Protocol) is the USB port for AI agents. PRANA ships an MCP server (`prana-mcp`) that exposes its whole brain — ReAct loop, tools, memory, scheduler — to any MCP-capable agent. After this guide, you can ask **Claude Code, Cursor, or ChatGPT Desktop** to *"use PRANA to schedule a daily briefing"* and it just works.

◈ The 5 brain tools your agents get

Tool	What it does
`prana_chat`	Run one task through PRANA's full brain (loop + tools + memory + personality mode). Returns the final answer.
`prana_remember`	Store a durable fact in long-term memory. Credentials are refused, never stored.
`prana_recall`	Search long-term memory for relevant snippets.
`prana_schedule`	Create a persistent scheduled job (cron / @daily / "every 30m"). The daemon runs it.
`prana_jobs`	List scheduled jobs: name, schedule, active state, delivery target.

API key for `prana_chat` resolves as: tool arg `key` → `OPENAI_API_KEY` / `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` / `GEMINI_API_KEY` env → `~/.prana/config.json`. Never logged, never echoed.

1 One-command install: prana-setup

🤖 AUTOMATIC

`prana-setup` does three things: saves your API key, **detects your installed agents**, and writes the MCP config for each — merging, never clobbering existing entries.

PowerShell

```
$ prana-setup
== prana setup — instant installer ==
python: C:\Users\YOU\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python314\python.exe

Paste API key (hidden, any provider): ••••••••
API key saved for openai → C:\Users\YOU\.prana\config.json (0600)

agents: Claude Code / Claude Desktop, Cursor
Write MCP configs? [Y/n] y
  Claude Code / Claude Desktop: configured → C:\Users\YOU\.claude.json
  Cursor: configured → C:\Users\YOU\.cursor\mcp.json
```

Non-interactive flavors

PowerShell

```
$ prana-setup --key sk-... --yes          # key + all detected agents, no prompts
$ prana-setup --agents claude,cursor        # only these agents
$ prana-setup --dry-run                    # preview what WOULD be written, change
nothing
$ prana-setup --check                      # verify installation health anytime
```

2 Restart your agent apps

👆 YOUR STEP

MCP configs load **at app startup**. After `prana-setup` writes them: **fully quit and reopen** Claude Desktop / Cursor / ChatGPT Desktop (not just the chat — the whole app). CLI agents (Claude Code, Codex CLI, Gemini CLI) pick it up on next launch.

Manual setup per agent

Prefer hand control, or want to understand what `prana-setup` wrote? Each agent, its file, and the exact block. **Replace the python path with YOUR full path** (see the Windows rule below).

Claude Code

`%USERPROFILE%\.claude.json`

.claude.json — merge into "mcpServers"

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "prana": {
      "command": "C:\\Users\\YOU\\AppData\\Local\\Programs\\Python\\Python314\\python.exe",
      "args": ["-m", "prana.mcp_server"]
    }
  }
}
```

Claude Desktop

`%APPDATA%\Claude\claude_desktop_config.json`

Same `mcpServers.prana` block as above. Then **fully quit and reopen** Claude Desktop.

Cursor

`%USERPROFILE%\.cursor\mcp.json`

Same `mcpServers.prana` block as above. Then **restart Cursor**.

Codex CLI / ChatGPT Desktop

`%USERPROFILE%\.codex\config.toml`

TOML format — append this block:

config.toml

```
# add at the end of the file (idempotent — never duplicate)
[mcp_servers.prana]
command = "C:\\Users\\YOU\\AppData\\Local\\Programs\\Python\\Python314\\python.exe"
args = ["-m", "prana.mcp_server"]
```

ChatGPT Desktop shares this file with Codex CLI. Verify with `/mcp` in chat after reopening.

Gemini CLI

`%USERPROFILE%\.gemini\settings.json`

Same `mcpServers.prana` JSON block as Claude Code.

Antigravity (manual only — no config file)

Agent panel → **...** → **MCP Servers** → **View raw config** → paste:

raw config JSON

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "prana": {
      "command": "C:\\Users\\YOU\\AppData\\Local\\Programs\\Python\\Python314\\python.exe",
      "args": ["-m", "prana.mcp_server"]
    }
  }
}
```

⚠ The Windows full-path rule

> **⛔ NEVER USE A BARE "PYTHON"**
>
> **GUI apps (Claude Desktop, Cursor, ChatGPT Desktop) do NOT inherit your terminal PATH.** A bare `"command": "python"` will silently fail to start the server. Always use the **full python path** — this is exactly what `prana-setup` writes automatically.

Find YOUR path (yours will differ — never copy the example blindly):

PowerShell

```
$ py -c "import sys; print(sys.executable)"
C:\Users\YOU\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python314\python.exe
# in JSON, backslashes must be doubled: C:\\Users\\YOU\\...
```

> **⚠️ PIP ≠ PYTHON TRAP**
>
> On some machines `pip` and `python` point to **different** Pythons. Always install with `python -m pip install -e .` (or `py -m pip`) using the *same* interpreter that's in your MCP config. Switched interpreters later? Re-run `prana-setup`.

✓ Verify it works

- ✅ Run `prana-setup --check` → ends with **"All green — PRANA is ready."**
- ✅ Restart the agent app (full quit → reopen)
- ✅ In the agent's chat/tools panel, confirm **prana** appears with its 5 tools
- ✅ Ask it: *"use prana_chat to summarize what PRANA can do, teacher mode"*

Troubleshooting

Error / symptom	Fix
`"No MCP server named prana is currently connected"`	The server isn't starting. #1 cause: bare `python` in config (GUI PATH issue) → use the **full python path**. Then fully quit + reopen the app.
`Settings show prana "Enabled" but chat says not connected`	Same root cause — the settings UI reads the config, but the server process failed to launch. Fix the command path, restart.
`ChatGPT web can't see PRANA`	Expected — the web app can't run local stdio servers (HTTPS remote only). Use **ChatGPT Desktop**, which shares `~/.codex/config.toml`.
`Edited config, agent still doesn't see it`	MCP configs load at startup. **Fully quit and reopen** the app — not just the chat window.
`prana_chat says "no API key found"`	Key resolution: tool arg `key` → env (`OPENAI_API_KEY` / `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` / `GEMINI_API_KEY`) → `~/.prana/config.json`. Run `prana --save-key` once and it works everywhere.
`Tools work, then break after a Python reinstall`	The full python path in the config now points nowhere. Re-run `prana-setup` to rewrite it.
`Corrupt JSON config after hand-editing`	`prana-setup` never clobbers: it merges into `mcpServers` and validates. Re-run it to repair.

Quick reference

Agent	Config file (Windows)	Format
Claude Code	`%USERPROFILE%\.claude.json`	JSON `mcpServers`
Claude Desktop	`%APPDATA%\Claude\claude_desktop_config.json`	JSON `mcpServers`
Cursor	`%USERPROFILE%\.cursor\mcp.json`	JSON `mcpServers`
Codex CLI / ChatGPT Desktop	`%USERPROFILE%\.codex\config.toml`	TOML `[mcp_servers.prana]`
Gemini CLI	`%USERPROFILE%\.gemini\settings.json`	JSON `mcpServers`
Antigravity	UI: Agent panel → ... → MCP Servers → View raw config	paste JSON block

Command	Does
`prana-setup`	Interactive: key + detected agents + channel steps
`prana-setup --check`	Health check — "All green" when ready
`prana-setup --dry-run`	Preview writes without changing anything
`prana-mcp`	Run the MCP server directly (stdio)

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